
Leadership and Peer Support, Grade 11, Open

(GPP3O)

This course prepares students to act in leadership and peer support roles. They will design and implement a plan for contributing to their school and/or community; develop skills in communication, interpersonal relations, teamwork, and conflict management; and apply those skills in leadership and/or peer support roles – for example, as a student council member or a peer tutor. Students will examine group dynamics and learn the value of diversity within groups and communities.

Prerequisite: None

Personal Knowledge and Management Skills

Overall Expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

- explain how their personal characteristics and acquired skills may affect their interactions with others in leadership and peer support roles;
- identify the characteristics of an effective leader and use these to evaluate their own leadership and peer support capabilities;
- identify and apply the personal-management skills and characteristics required to succeed in leadership and peer support roles;
- identify and apply effective teaching and learning strategies and resources to help others through leadership and peer support roles.

Specific Expectations

Personal Knowledge

By the end of this course, students will:

- identify and differentiate between their personal characteristics and skills they have developed over time, based on information gathered through self-assessment (e.g., personality inventories, interest tests, feedback from others);
- summarize their leadership qualities and experiences, and describe how they may affect interactions with others in leadership and peer support roles;
- explain how a variety of factors (e.g., culture, family background, personal experiences, the media) have influenced their personal motivation and skills related to leadership and peer support roles;
- create a personal profile reflecting the results of their self-assessment and incorporate it into their portfolio.

Leadership Qualities

By the end of this course, students will:

- research and identify the leadership qualities and styles of a diverse range of people, including Aboriginal individuals, in leadership and support roles (e.g., in sports, politics, community, and/or school);

- describe various learning styles (e.g., auditory, visual, kinesthetic) and identify strategies used to support people with these learning styles;
- describe a set of criteria (e.g., personal-management skills, personal characteristics) to assess the effectiveness of individuals in leadership and peer support roles, and use these criteria to assess their own strengths and needs for further development.

Personal Management

By the end of this course, students will:

- identify and describe personal-management strategies that contribute to academic success (e.g., strategies for dealing with homework, tests, missed classes, workload, procrastination), and demonstrate how to communicate these strategies in tutoring and mentoring roles;
- demonstrate an understanding and appropriate application of the principles and protocols related to confidentiality and privacy rights (e.g., referral of an issue to the appropriate teacher or department) in a variety of leadership and peer support roles;

- explain how acquiring experience in leadership and peer support roles at school and in the community can help them achieve their present and future goals (e.g., meeting diploma requirements for community involvement, developing skills for specific jobs, attaining scholarships and awards);
- maintain an updated résumé and portfolio to reflect their abilities, skills, and experiences in leadership and peer support roles at school and in the community.
- identify and describe challenges (e.g., emotional, motivational, learning, socio-economic, family-related) to effective learning and goal achievement;
- explain how to recognize challenges to learning in others and how to determine their own role in helping others address these challenges;
- describe school and community support programs and services (e.g., guidance services, social service agencies, cultural and religious organizations, mentorship programs available to support students' needs) and explain how to access them.

Strategies and Resources

By the end of this course, students will:

- demonstrate an understanding of a range of teaching and learning strategies (e.g., positive reinforcement, individualized instruction, task management) that can be applied to assist others in achieving their goals;

Interpersonal Knowledge and Skills

Overall Expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

- use strategies that promote positive interpersonal relationships as they pertain to leadership and/or peer support;
- demonstrate effective use of communication skills in a variety of settings;
- apply theories related to group dynamics and leadership in various situations;
- explain how community dynamics affect leadership and peer support roles.

Specific Expectations

Interpersonal Relations

By the end of this course, students will:

- identify the elements that contribute to building positive self-esteem (e.g., maintaining optimism, recovering from mistakes, overcoming fears, achieving goals, accepting positive reinforcement from others);
- describe the elements of effective interpersonal relations (e.g., respect for differences, commitment to equity and fairness, flexibility, honesty, integrity) and demonstrate their use in selected leadership and peer support roles in school or in the community;
- describe a conflict-resolution model and demonstrate its use in a variety of situations to reduce conflict and reach mutually agreeable solutions;
- identify sources of pressure on adolescents (e.g., peer behaviour and attitudes, family relationships, prejudice, discrimination, media influences), and appropriate strategies to deal with these pressures.

Communication Skills

By the end of this course, students will:

- describe the elements of effective communication (e.g., active listening, non-judgemental statements, paraphrasing)

and demonstrate their use in selected leadership and peer support roles in school or in the community (e.g., tutoring, mentoring, coaching, mediating, assisting with school or community projects);

- explain the benefits and pitfalls of expressing emotions, and demonstrate appropriate ways of managing their own emotions and responding to others' expressions of emotions;
- demonstrate an understanding of how to respond appropriately (e.g., remaining calm, empathizing, recommending a referral) to peers' disclosures of serious personal matters (e.g., health problems, physical and emotional abuse, bullying, exclusion, discrimination, family issues, harassment, substance abuse);
- demonstrate the ability to provide feedback to help others identify their strengths and areas needing improvement.

Group Dynamics

By the end of this course, students will:

- describe theories of group dynamics (e.g., theories describing stages of group development, roles of group members) and produce an analysis of the dynamics of groups in which they participate;

- demonstrate a variety of team-building strategies (e.g., listening, task sharing, providing positive feedback and constructive criticism, building consensus, identifying and using strengths of group members) and explain how they facilitate positive interaction and improve group and individual results;
 - explain how selected leadership styles (e.g., autocratic, democratic, delegative) and strategies (e.g., organizing groups, soliciting support, setting goals) affect group interaction and results;
 - demonstrate effective use of leadership skills in classroom groups and in planning school or community events.
- explain how cultural diversity within groups may affect communication, interpersonal relations, and leadership styles, both positively and negatively;
 - explain how power can be used positively (e.g., to promote engagement and inclusion) or misused (e.g., in situations involving bullying, exclusion, workplace harassment) in work, family, and peer contexts, and identify strategies to deal with situations where power is misused;
 - describe their rights (e.g., a safe environment, freedom from harassment and discrimination, adequate training) and responsibilities (e.g., adhering to ethical behaviour, maintaining confidentiality, showing respect for others and their property, following safety procedures) in various leadership and peer support roles.

Connecting With the Community

By the end of this course, students will:

- describe the dimensions of diversity within their community (e.g., gender, race, culture, ethnicity, ability, sexual orientation, age, religion, socioeconomic level) and identify the value of diversity as well as the challenges it poses;

Exploration of Opportunities

Overall Expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

- describe, on the basis of research, the range of leadership and peer support opportunities in the school and the community, and identify those to which they are most suited;
- demonstrate the ability to design and implement a plan or program that addresses needs identified in the school or the community;
- identify a range of careers and postsecondary options requiring skills in leadership and peer support.

Specific Expectations

Accessing Options

By the end of this course, students will:

- produce a comprehensive list of the leadership and peer support opportunities available in their school and community, using print, electronic, and human resources;
- analyse selected leadership or peer support roles (e.g., tutor, student host, team captain, student council member) in terms of responsibilities of the role, skills required, time commitments, and benefits and challenges;
- evaluate their own suitability for a selected leadership or peer support role and provide a rationale for their choice of role.

Developing a Plan

By the end of this course, students will:

- identify an opportunity within the school or community (e.g., orientation for new students to the school, career fair, school arts showcase, community agency fair, social justice event, fund-raising events) where they can take a leadership and/or support role;
- design and present a plan to address a need identified within the school or community where they can make a positive contribution;
- use appropriate software in accessing and managing information and producing

materials appropriate to their plan (e.g., advertising brochure, posters, orientation day agenda);

- design an evaluation tool (e.g., survey, feedback form) to assess the plan or program that they have developed.

Exploring Careers

By the end of this course, students will:

- identify occupations or fields of work that require skills in leadership and peer support;
- investigate postsecondary programs and learning options for careers requiring skills in leadership and peer support, using a variety of resources (e.g., course calendars, informational interviews, guest speakers, Internet websites), and identify those to which they are most suited;
- explain the relationships among personal experiences, lifelong learning, and career development.